

Philipp Hilbert. *Staff PM, global device lifecycle operations.*

Positioning, ten years shipping operational platforms across logistics, data, and regulated infrastructure, now ready to automate the last miles of Deel IT.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

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§ WHY DEEL

Deel IT is one of the few internal operations problems with the scale, geographic spread, and financial stakes of an external SaaS product: 150+ countries, 50+ suppliers, real SLAs, and a cost of failure the whole company feels. The specific opportunity, automating the manual workflows that sit on top of two platforms that already work, while simultaneously unlocking supplier capacity to absorb more complexity, is exactly the kind of systems-level problem I find most interesting to solve. The fact that the engineering team is growing from 8 to 18 means the constraint is not capacity, it is a clear point of view on what to build next. *That is precisely the gap I am built to close.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, pair-programming across Python and SQL
- **Cursor**, context-rich code navigation and LLM-assisted edits
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, research synthesis and decision documents
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder communication and roadmap decks
- **Framer**, interactive prototypes and design iteration

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, ArgoCD, GitOps, Docker, OpenShift, Jenkins, CI/CD, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, REST APIs, Azure DevOps, GitLab, Jira, Confluence, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT DEEL

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the operations team and supplier managers, pull ticket data and SLA dashboards, and map every workflow where a human is still in the loop that the existing platform could theoretically own.

WEEK 2

Rank, scope, validate.

Score each automation candidate by engineering effort, operational headcount cost, and SLA risk reduction; present a first opinionated roadmap slice and pressure-test it with the engineering lead and two supplier contacts.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, close.

Drive the first automation to staging, instrument the metric that proves it works (e.g. shipping-label generation cycle time), and build the early-warning dashboard that surfaces SLA risk before it becomes a crisis.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

Deel IT's problem is specific and the brief is honest about it: two platforms that handle real scale already exist, and what is missing is the judgment to automate the manual workflows that live on top of them and to unlock what suppliers can actually do. That is a systems problem, not a

backlog-grooming problem. It is the kind of work I have spent the past decade doing in regulated, high-stakes operational environments.

At Rohde & Schwarz I inherited a multinational AI and data platform where rollout took days and could not carry a hotfix. I introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD, cut rollout time to thirty minutes, and made the platform hotfix-capable, without disrupting ongoing delivery. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline, introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly data imports ran without hand-holding, and migrated the platform fully into containers, putting the team in autonomous control of its own environments. Both roles required the same motion: map the whole system, find where human effort is replacing platform capability, and remove the human from the loop one workflow at a time.

The supplier expansion opportunity resonates directly with work I did at EMIL Group, where I rebuilt an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams with their own leads after it had been losing senior engineers and client trust. The pattern is the same: an external party (there, a client; here, a supplier network) wants to do more and is being held back by internal structure. The answer is rarely a feature, it is figuring out which constraint is real and which is just accumulated friction.

On AI as a daily working mode: I use Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, and n8n actively, not as experiments. I build agentic workflows, write and run prompts to synthesise unstructured operational data, and prototype front-ends fast enough to validate assumptions before writing a requirements document. I also built my own multi-agent coding framework (Liberation of Bajor) and a backtesting engine, which means I understand the infrastructure constraints that agentic systems run into at scale.

The logistics depth comes from two directions: a Master's specialisation at TU Berlin and the practical reality of building Kvitt Payment Solutions from zero to acquisition inside the girocard ecosystem, where payment rails and operational logistics are the same thing. I am not a logistics veteran, but I am not starting from a blank page either.

I would welcome the chance to talk through the specific automation roadmap priorities and where an experienced systems thinker would add the most leverage in the first ninety days.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager with 13 years of end-to-end ownership in regulated, operationally complex environments, defence AI, public-sector data platforms, insurance SaaS, payments, and healthcare. I take loosely-defined, data-rich problem spaces, diagnose where human effort is substituting for platform capability, and ship the automation that closes the gap. Strongest in the moment between "the platform works" and "the platform scales without adding headcount."

§ WHAT I CAN DO

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, Explainable AI (XAI); Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Analytics and Data: KPI definition, funnel and churn analysis, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, GitOps, Docker, OpenShift, Jenkins, CI/CD, Python, Kotlin, Django, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Azure DevOps, GitLab.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile, agile release trains, PI planning.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

Logistics and SaaS domains: Logistics specialisation (TU Berlin), B2B SaaS platform ownership (EMIL Group), marketplace operations (construct8).

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI/DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

Introduced GitOps with ArgoCD across a multinational team; cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes and made the platform hotfix-capable. Redirected product scope based on instrumented usage data.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR DATA PLATFORM 2023-2024

Integrated test automation into Jenkins, introduced Dagster and dbt for autonomous data imports, migrated bare-metal to containers, and carried a full UI relaunch. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut a three-person team's roadmap to the top 10% of features; user acceptance rose more than fivefold. Implemented the CGM/KIS interface personally, reducing anamnesis time from 30 to 5 minutes.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Rebuilt an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total to one departure. Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production, cutting time-to-market from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · INTERIM PRODUCT OWNER · GOVERNMENT SECURE DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute's DIM and DESH programmes.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2019-2020

Migrated a legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE CLINICAL NETWORK 2017-2018

WLAN rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero-to-one B2B two-sided marketplace. Anonymity-until-payment model; LLM agents across the funnel so one person runs the operation.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer encryption product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER CDO/CFO · NANOTECHNOLOGY AGRICULTURE 2018-2021

Laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built from zero to acquisition; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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